Stories and support types

All stories are made up. Use them for class work. You do not need to tell a real story.

A A changed routine

A young person has a new morning routine. For several days they feel worried and find it hard to focus on a short task. They want help to plan the first step.

B Missing an activity

A young person has not joined a quiet activity they used to like for a while. They say they feel low most days and would like to speak to an adult.

C A tired start

A young person says their sleep has been very different for a while. They feel tired and find a daily task hard. They want help but are not sure what to say.

Who could help

Type	What they could do
A trusted adult	Listens and helps find a safe next step.
School staff	Can help at school and find more support.
A family doctor	Can discuss health and help find suitable care.
A helpline	Can listen or give advice. Ask staff to help find one suited to the person's age and need.

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A line to keep

This card is private and optional. Keep it. Do not hand it in. You may use a made-up person, leave it blank or pass. Use roles, not names. No real worry or health detail is needed.

If I needed support I could

_____

_____

Some words to choose

ask a trusted adult · talk to school staff · ask for help to speak to a family doctor · ask staff to find a suitable helpline

A private way to ask

Can we talk in private? I would like some help. You can use words, a note, HELP or your usual aid.

If help is not enough

Ask another trusted adult or use the school help route. You can ask before a problem is severe.

Pause and return

Use the quiet pause signal agreed with staff. An adult will help with the known safe route. You do not need to explain to the group. Come back with support or use a neutral task.

Staff note: support a blank card without pressing. Do not collect or copy it. Any disclosure goes to the safeguarding lead through school procedure. Do not promise a secret.

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Aids for the story work

Keep your words, starter and model in view. Use your usual aids. Plan in any language.

Starter

Words: health · thoughts · feelings · everyone

Start: Mental health is…

Model: Mental health is part of everyone's health.

Signs and meaning

Words: may · change · daily life · help

Start: The story says… This may mean…

Model: The story says worry makes a task hard. Support may help.

Model and guided choice

Words: listen · school staff · first step

Start: The person could ask…

Model: The person could ask school staff for help with the new routine.

Private hinge

Words: sign · cause · diagnosis · support

Start: A sign can… It cannot…

Model: A sign can show a need for support. It cannot prove a diagnosis.

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Aids for your next response

Main task choice

Words: clue · adult · request · reason

Start: The person could… because…

Model: The person could ask a trusted adult because daily life feels hard.

Private keep card

Words: if · support · could · ask

Start: If I needed support I could…

Model: If the story person needed support they could ask school staff in private.

Review and exit

Words: check · next step · help · reply

Start: One safe next step is…

Model: One safe next step is to ask another trusted adult if help is not enough.

Two task choices

Map B or advice note C. Both show what mental health means, a clue, support type and reason, a private opener and a fallback. Write in a book, type on Evidence page 2, point, use an aid or an exact scribe.

Help in private

You can pass or ask for a supported pause. For real help, ask a trusted adult in private. If one is busy, ask another. No one needs a diagnosis before asking for help.

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